

Silver HMO 2026 - Benefits & Authorization Policy

Document ID	SILVER-HMO-2026
Plan Type	Silver HMO
Effective Date	2026-01-01
Policy Domain	Benefits & Authorization
Status	Active

SECTION 1: POLICY SCOPE

This policy applies to members enrolled in the Silver HMO plan for plan year 2026. Covered services generally require use of the HMO network except where emergency-care rules apply.

SECTION 2: ADVANCED DIAGNOSTIC IMAGING

Non-emergency MRI, CT and PET procedures require prior authorization. Emergency imaging is exempt from prior authorization when performed as part of an emergency department encounter.

SECTION 3: PHYSICAL THERAPY

The first 6 physical therapy visits in a benefit year do not require prior authorization. Prior authorization is required beginning with the 7th visit. Continued therapy requests must include clinical progress and a treatment plan.

SECTION 4: SPECIALIST REFERRALS

A referral from the member's assigned primary-care provider is required before a routine specialist visit. Emergency and urgent-care services are excluded from the referral requirement.

SECTION 5: CHIROPRACTIC SERVICES

Chiropractic services are limited to 12 covered visits per benefit year when medically necessary.

SECTION 6: MEMBER RESPONSIBILITY

Authorization or referral approval does not guarantee claim payment. Eligibility, network status, benefit limits and coding requirements are evaluated at claim adjudication.

Training note: This document is synthetic and created only for AI/RAG training.